

Why do I get hungry?

You need to eat food to give you energy for playing, thinking, and growing—and everything else you do. When your stomach is empty, a chemical inside it sends a message to your brain telling you that it's time to eat.

Quick quiz

- ☒ How do you know when you need to eat?
- ☒ Where does most digestion take place?
- ☒ Where is your feces made?

Pulpy mash

You use your teeth and tongue to mash food into a pulp. Your tongue then pushes the pulp to the back of your throat, so you can swallow it.

Slimy saliva

Your salivary glands (shown in yellow) produce saliva (or spit). Saliva makes food wetter, which helps you to swallow it.

Your

stomach can stretch to 20 times its size after you eat.

Churning food

Strong muscles in your stomach churn your food into a creamy liquid. This makes it easier to digest (absorb the goodness).

Down the tube.....

After you swallow food, it travels down a tube called the esophagus. After about 10 seconds, it reaches your stomach.

Food factory

Your liver is a kind of food factory, performing lots of jobs. It makes sure the different parts of your food go to the right places in your body.....

